



CARE & FINISHING GUIDE

SourcePoint Valera Fiberglass Doors

Version 1.0 • Keep this guide with your warranty documents.



IF YOUR DOOR CAME PRIMED, FINISH IT — ALL SIX SIDES — WITHIN 30 DAYS

Paint or stain the face, the back, both edges, **the top edge, and the bottom edge**, plus every bore hole, mortise pocket, and cut edge. If it is a wet season, finish it right away. **Primer is not a finish.**

If your door came factory-finished, leave it alone. Do not paint, stain, sand, or strip it. Clean it and touch up chips — nothing more.

And it needs an overhang. A Valera door that is not shielded from the elements by adequate overhang is not covered — see the Overhang Requirement in your warranty.

Valera doors have a fiberglass skin over a wood frame. The skin will not rust, dent, or absorb water, and under an overhang the slab is warranted for five years. **The wood inside is only as protected as the edges you seal.** Water that gets into an unsealed edge or bore hole swells the stile and pushes the skin off, and that is not covered. Everything in this guide comes down to keeping the edges sealed and the finish sound. It is not much work. Do it on schedule.

INSTALLATION

Before and During Installation

- **Unwrap and inspect the door as soon as you receive it — before installation.** Concealed damage is damage you cannot see until the packaging comes off. Report it to your dealer, in writing, within **24 hours of your receipt**. Report any other defect before the door is installed, altered, trimmed, or finished. A door that has been installed or finished is treated as accepted.
- **Store it dry, supported, and out of the sun.** Flat with spacers between stacked units, or upright on a padded edge and leaned no more than a few degrees. Keep it indoors or fully covered. **Never leave a wrapped door in direct sun** — the plastic traps heat and can bubble the skin or the factory finish before the door is ever hung. In humid weather, slit the shipping wrap so it can breathe. Never let the door stand in water — the bottom edge is wood and will wick it up.
- **Confirm the overhang before the door goes in.** The requirement is **X = ½Y**: the overhang must project from the wall at least half the distance from the bottom of the door to the base of the overhang. A door 10 feet below the overhang needs 5 feet of projection. More is needed on south- and west-facing walls and where wind drives rain at the door. If the opening does not meet it, talk to your dealer before you install — it cannot be fixed afterward.
- **Do not cut down, trim, or add cutouts to the door.** Alterations void coverage. Trimming brickmould to fit the opening is fine.
- **Pre-hung units go in as a unit.** Do not remove the slab from the frame to install the frame, and do not re-bore for hardware after delivery.
- Professional installation is strongly recommended. Waterproofing — flashing, sill pan, sealant — is the customer's responsibility.

FINISHING

Finishing a Primed Door — Required

Every primed Valera door must be finished on all six sides within 30 days of installation — sooner if it is installed during a wet season. You can paint it, or on a woodgrain-textured door, stain it. What you cannot do is leave it in primer, or finish it with the wrong product.

Which finish system

IF YOU ARE

USE

Painting

A quality **100% acrylic exterior latex paint** formulated for fiberglass or exterior doors, applied over the factory primer

Staining (woodgrain doors only)

A **gel stain formulated for fiberglass doors**, top-coated with an **exterior-grade clear finish containing UV inhibitors**



DO NOT USE INTERIOR PAINT, INTERIOR POLYURETHANE, LACQUER, OR SHELLAC

They are not made for weather. Do not use penetrating oil stains made for wood — fiberglass cannot absorb them and they will not cure. Do not use any product whose instructions require sanding the door surface.

Primer is not a finish. The factory primer is a bonding layer for your topcoat. It is not a weather coat and it will chalk and let go if left exposed.

The edges are the job. The face and back of the door are fiberglass and would survive a missed coat. The top edge, bottom edge, and both side edges are wood, and they are what the six-sides rule is really about. Coat them as carefully as the face — more carefully, because you will not look at them again.

Before you start — every door

1. Wipe the whole door down with a clean cloth and mild detergent in warm water to remove dust, handling oils, and mold-release residue. Rinse with clean water. Let it dry completely.
2. **Do not sand.** The primer is ready to accept paint or stain. Sanding a woodgrain door flattens the texture; sanding a smooth door scratches it. If a spot needs it, a light scuff with a **fine (maroon) non-woven pad** is the most you should do.
3. Work in the shade, between **50°F and 90°F**, with the door out of direct sun. Finish applied to a hot door skins over before it levels and does not bond.
4. Remove or mask the hardware, weatherstrip, and glass. Do not paint the weatherstrip — painted weatherstrip stiffens and stops sealing.

If you are painting

1. Apply the first coat of exterior acrylic latex with a quality synthetic brush or a foam roller, working with the grain on textured doors. Cover all six sides. Keep coats thin — two thin coats bond better and level better than one heavy one.
2. Let it dry the full time on the can — typically **4 to 6 hours** — before recoating.
3. Apply the second coat.
4. Let the door cure **24 hours** before reinstalling hardware, and keep it from closing hard against the weatherstrip for the first few days.

If you are staining

1. Test the gel stain on the **top edge** first. Fiberglass stain is darkened by working time and by how much you wipe off, not by number of coats, so the test tells you how to handle the rest of the door.
2. Work **one section at a time** — a stile, a rail, a panel — and complete each section before moving on. Brush the gel stain on with the grain, then wipe with a clean lint-free cloth in the direction of the grain until you have the color and the grain reads through. Feather the edges of each section into the next. **Stain all six sides.**
3. Let the stain dry the full time on the can — typically **24 to 48 hours** — before topcoating. Gel stain that is not fully dry will lift into the clear coat.
4. Apply the clear topcoat in thin coats, with the grain, on all six sides. Let each coat dry per the label — typically **4 to 6 hours** — and apply **at least two coats**; three on a south- or west-facing door.
5. Let the door cure **24 hours** before reinstalling hardware.

At installation

Seal every surface you expose by fitting the door — hinge routs, lock bores, mortise pockets, and any trimmed brickmould edge — **when you hang it**. Every one of those cuts goes through the finish and into the wood frame, and a bare bore hole is the one place water can get straight into the door.

Factory-Finished Doors

Do nothing but clean it and touch up chips. Painting, staining, sanding, or stripping a factory-finished door ends the factory-finish coverage, and whatever goes on over the factory finish is not covered.

Touch-up. Clean the chip or scratch with mild detergent and water, let it dry, and apply the touch-up product supplied with the door, or a matching exterior acrylic latex, with a small artist's brush. Build up in thin layers. Do not sand the surrounding finish.

ONGOING CARE

Ongoing Care — Required to Keep Coverage

DO THIS

HOW OFTEN

Inspect the finish, top and bottom edges, and every bore hole

Every **12 months**

Refinish

When the finish shows wear — typically every **5 to 7 years** for paint, **3 to 5 years** for stain, sooner on south- and west-facing doors

Clean the door

Twice a year — monthly within two miles of salt water

Keep a dated record. Delamination and skin-failure claims may need proof that the finish was inspected and kept up. A photograph with the date on it, a contractor's invoice, or the log at the back of this guide all work.

What "shows wear" looks like: the finish is dull or chalky (a white residue comes off on your finger), the color has thinned so primer or fiberglass shows through, or the clear coat on a stained door has gone cloudy, checked, or started to peel. **Recoat before it gets through to the primer.** Refinishing over a sound, cleaned finish is a wash-and-recoat; refinishing a door that has gone through to bare fiberglass means starting over.

Refinishing. Wash the door, let it dry, scuff the old finish lightly with a fine non-woven pad, wipe it clean, and recoat with the same type of product as before — paint over paint, clear over clear. Do not strip a fiberglass door.

Clean the door twice a year — more often on the coast or near a road — with mild detergent and warm water on a soft cloth or sponge. Rinse and wipe dry.

 **Do not use** abrasive cleaners, scouring pads, ammonia-based glass cleaners on decorative glass coming, paint thinner, lacquer thinner, acetone, gasoline, kerosene, bleach, or any solvent on the door, the finish, the glass, or the hardware. Do not pressure-wash the door.

SEALS

Weatherstrip, Sweep, and Threshold

These are the parts that wear, and they are the reason a door leaks air or water long before anything is wrong with the door itself.

- **Keep the weatherstrip clean.** Wipe it down with mild soap and water when you clean the door. Grit left in the weatherstrip abrades it and breaks the seal.
- **Do not paint it.** Painted weatherstrip stiffens and stops sealing. Replace weatherstrip that is torn, compressed flat, or no longer springs back — it is designed to be replaced, and your dealer can supply it.
- **Check the sweep** at the bottom of the door once a year. If you can see daylight under the door with it closed, or feel air, the sweep has worn or the threshold needs adjusting.
- **Adjust the threshold** if fitted with an adjustable cap: raise it until the sweep just contacts it evenly across the width of the door. Too high binds the door and tears the sweep; too low lets water in.
- **Keep the sill clean** and the weep slots at the exterior of the sill clear so water that lands on the sill drains out, not in.
- **Check the corner seals** where the weatherstrip meets the sill each year. They are small, they are cheap, and they are the most common point of water entry on any entry door.

HARDWARE & GLASS

Hardware

- **Hinges.** Tighten the screws once a year. Put a drop of light machine oil on each hinge pin as needed and wipe off the excess. A squeak is a hinge asking for oil, not a defect.

- **Lockset and handle.** Locksets are not part of the Valera unit. Follow the hardware manufacturer's care instructions. As a rule: wipe with a soft damp cloth and dry, tighten screws when needed, and keep solvents and abrasive polishes off plated finishes.
- **Within two miles of salt water,** rinse hinges and hardware with fresh water **every month** and dry them. Salt left on a plated finish will pit it in one season. Corrosion of hardware in a coastal location is not covered.

Glass

- Clean with mild soap and water or a **non-ammonia** glass cleaner on a soft cloth. Ammonia and abrasive cleaners dull the coming on decorative glass and can etch coated glass.
- Do not scrape glass with a razor or blade.
- **Do not apply films, tints, or coatings.** They stress the glass unit, cause seal failure, and void glass coverage.
- Fog or moisture **between** the panes that does not wipe off is a seal failure — contact your dealer. Moisture on the **inside surface** is condensation — see below.

Condensation

Exterior doors can sweat when interior humidity is high or a heat register sits near the door. This is not a manufacturing defect and is not covered, but standing moisture will damage the trim and the flooring. Wipe it up promptly, lower interior humidity, and run exhaust fans in kitchens and baths.

THE MATERIAL

What to Expect from the Material

- **A dark door will bow slightly in the afternoon sun and flatten back overnight.** This is heat, not warp, and it is normal. Warp is measured with the door cool.
- **Woodgrain texture repeats.** The molded grain on a textured door is a pattern, and it will not match the sidelite, the frame, or a real wood door.
- **Components take stain differently.** A stained fiberglass skin, wood edge, composite frame, and lite frame are three different materials and will not be a perfect color match.
- **Field-applied finishes chalk.** All exterior paint chinks eventually; it is the finish weathering as designed. Wash it off and recoat when it gets thin.
- **Fading is uneven.** The south and west faces of the house get more sun than the north, and the finish on those elevations will fade first.

SEASONAL

Seasonal Checks

- Look at the **top and bottom edges** and every bore hole at each scheduled inspection. These are where a field finish fails first and where water gets in.
- Check that the door still swings freely and closes without binding or slamming.
- Check the weatherstrip contact all the way around, the sweep, and the corner seals.
- Confirm the threshold and sill are draining and that sealant at the perimeter is intact.
- Check that no third-party item — mail slot, pet door, speakeasy — has been fastened through the door.

VOID CONDITIONS

What Voids Your Warranty

- Installing the door without adequate overhang — **X = ½Y** — see the Overhang Requirement in your warranty
- Leaving a primed door unfinished past 30 days, or leaving it in primer only
- Finishing with interior paint, interior polyurethane, lacquer, shellac, a wood penetrating stain, or any product other than a permitted system
- Painting, staining, sanding, or stripping a factory-finished door (voids finish coverage)
- Cutting down, trimming, or adding cutouts to the door
- Fastening third-party items through the door — mail slots, speakeasies, pet doors, and similar
- Re-boring or changing hardware after delivery in a way that penetrates the door
- **Installing a storm door of any type,** vented or non-vented
- Storing the door improperly before installation, including leaving it wrapped in the sun
- Failing to inspect and refinish on the schedule above
- Applying films, tints, or coatings to the glass (voids glass coverage)

What Is Not Covered

These do not void your warranty. The specific damage is simply not covered:

- Damage from heat build-up where a **dark paint or stain has been field-applied**. A dark finish is one with a Light Reflectance Value below 40. Factory-applied dark finishes are covered.
- Normal chalking, fading within tolerance, and uneven fading between elevations
- Temporary heat bow, and minor warp within tolerance
- The performance or appearance of any finish applied by anyone other than SourcePoint
- Locksets, handle sets, and the finish on any hardware
- Corrosion, pitting, or tarnish of metal components within two miles of salt water
- Wear of weatherstrip, sweep, and corner seals after the first year
- Condensation and damage resulting from it
- Glass breakage and glass scratches
- Water entering around the door — flashing, sealant, and installation are the installer’s responsibility

Maintenance Log

DATE	WHAT YOU DID	PRODUCT USED

Questions about your door? Contact your SourcePoint dealer. They are your first point of contact for product questions, replacement parts, and warranty claims.

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